



INDIAN COUNCIL FOR CULTURAL RELATIONS
AZAD BHAVAN, IP ESTATE, NEW DELHI-110002
(SCHOLARSHIP DIVISION)
(AY 2025-26)

GENERAL GUIDELINES FOR ZONAL/SUB ZONAL OFFICES/RP OFFICE OF ICCR

(A) Standard Operating Procedure to be followed by Zonal/Sub Zonal Offices/RP Offices on arrival of international students under ICCR sponsored scholarship schemes:-

On Arrival

- (i) On receipt of travel plans of the selected students, the RO/University/Institute is to make necessary arrangements for receiving the student from the airport/railway station/ bus stand. If ISA is providing this facility, RO shall liaise with ISA.
- (ii) On arrival, a welcome kit shall be handed over. The kit should contain addresses, email, mobile no. of Zonal/Sub Zonal Office/RP Office, ISA, FRRO, city guide booklet, financial norms of ICCR sponsored Scholarship Scheme in which student is enrolled, Bank Account opening information and any other relevant information (such as medical insurance in India) as deemed appropriate by Zonal/Sub Zonal office/RP office.
- (iii) Facilitate student in completion of admission formalities.
- (iv) To help student in registering with Foreign Regional Registration Office within a period of 14 days.
- (v) Immediately on their arrival students should to be given bank account opening form and a letter from ZO/SZO/RPO/University concerned recommending immediate opening of bank account at the nearest branch of State Bank of India.

Scholarship Dues

- (i) Advise the students to submit the Joining Report (JR) and the tuition fee claim as per prescribed proforma within one month of their joining the University/Institute. While filling up the JR, student may be advised to fill the details related to date of birth, nationality, course, college details, registration number, Mobile no. etc with utmost care. Further payment should be released to students only after receiving the joining reports from the students/Institutions.
- (ii) Maintain and update database of all the students in the format prescribed by Hqrs. It is advisable to separately maintain list of new students.
- (iii) Duly filled-in Joining Report and tuition claim should be sent to ICCR Headquarter along-with forwarding letter seeking approval of tuition fee claimed by the University/institute concerned. The same should also be uploaded on Gyan Setu App.

Orientation Programme

ZO's/SZO's/RPO's should organize Orientation Programme in collaboration with Universities/ Institutes for newly arriving students within one month of their arrival. Cultural immersion programme should also be organized by ZO/SZO/RPO in due course. Proposals for such programmes to be submitted separately for seeking approval of Hqrs.

Whatsapp Group

ZO's/SZO's/RPO's are advised to form a What's-app/similar group of students to remain in touch on a regular basis. ZO/SZO/RPO shall also visit college/institute/ISA regularly to meet students and ISA.

Academic Progress

ZO/SZO/RPO to monitor the Academic Progress of the students studying in the area of their jurisdiction and to ensure uploading of arrival, academic and financial details on Gyan Setu App.

Procedures to be followed at the time of completion of course

- (i) ZO/SZO/RPO should ensure that student should fill-up the Alumni details on alumni portal (<https://indiaalumni.almaconnect.com/alumni>) before leaving India. This will help Alumni to remain in touch with ICCR for future ICCR activities as well as be helpful in future if their children apply for ICCR scholarship etc.
- (ii) ZO/SZO/RPO should instruct the student to leave for his/her country immediately after the completion of the course/declaration of online consolidated results of all the semesters/final year. Under normal circumstances, the time gap between completion of course/declaration of consolidated results of all semesters/final year and final departure should not exceed 3 weeks time.
- (iii) It should be ensured that Bank Account is closed before student leaves India after completion of his/her studies. This will ensure security from misuse of the dormant bank account.

Norms for Ph.D Students

- (i) Ph.D – 36 to 66 Months (After 3 years, RO's should obtain recommendation letter for the duration required for completion of his/her course including viva-voice by his/her Guide/Supervisor).
- (ii) Ph.D scholars travelling outside the country of data collection are eligible to draw 2 months stipend and HRA for the ex-India period only once during their scholarship tenure, subject to the necessary certificate from their supervisor and invitation of host organization and advance approval from the concerned ZOs/SZOs/RPOs well in advance. All travel expenses are to be borne by the students themselves.

Change of Subject

ROs may allow the students to change the course subject to the following conditions:-

- (i) Course may be changed from Higher to Lower Level
- (ii) University has no objection to change the course
- (iii) No additional financial implications on ICCR.

(B) Guidelines for Payment of Stipend/House Rent /ACA/Thesis charges/Air fare etc.

The guidelines with respect to payment of stipend, House Rent Allowance (House Rent), Annual Contingent Allowance (ACA) and other admissible allowance in respect of ICCR sponsored international students stand modified as under:-

- (i) Payment of stipend & House Rent as per the following prescribed rates may be released together to all students staying inside/outside the hostel. No rent agreement/ Rent receipt is required. However, for records address proof from each of the student should be obtained.

Stipend (from the date of joining of the University/Institute- on pro-rata basis)

Sr. No.	Particulars	In Rs.
(i)	Undergraduate	18000/- per month
(ii)	Post Graduate	20000/- per month
(iii)	Ph.D	22000/- per month

House Rent Allowance (from the date of joining of the University/Institute- on pro-rata basis)

Sr. No.	Particulars	In Rs.
(i)	In Grade 1 cities	6500/- per month
(ii)	In other cities	5500/- per month

- (ii) Payment of Annual Contingent Grant (ACA) as per the following prescribed rates may be released at the beginning of the academic year along with stipend and House Rent.

Sr. No.	Particulars	In Rs.
(i)	Undergraduate	5000/- per annum
(ii)	Post Graduate (admitted in AY 2023-24 & onwards)	7000/- per annum
(iii)	Ph.D	12500/- per annum

- (iii) *ZOs/SZOs/RPOs may release one time thesis/dissertation grant to the students (as per following prescribed norms) only after student submits Project/Thesis completion certificate obtained from his/her supervisor/Guide.*

Sr. No.	Particulars	In Rs.
(i)	Ph.D Scholars	10000/-
(ii)	For all other courses where project report is required to be submitted	7000/-

- (iv) Students under AYUSH Scholarship Scheme will continue to be governed by terms and conditions of Ministry of Ayush. (guidelines as per annexure A,B and C)
- (v) All the above payments shall be made through PFMS. No cash payments are admissible.
- (vi) ZOs/SZOs/RPOs may ensure that hostel dues are settled by students before their departure or discontinuation of the Scholarship.
- (vii) *Examination fee paid by the student to clear his/her backlog will not be reimbursed by ICCR.*
- (viii) For Bangladeshi students, (India Scholarship (Bangladesh) Scheme and Border Guard Bangladesh Scholarship Scheme), they are entitled for return economy class air-fares from Kolkata to Dhaka and 3rd AC Train fare from Place of Study to Airport, if so required. No payment to be released without submission of Original ticket bill and boarding pass.
- (ix) For Sri Lankan students, Nehru Memorial Scholarship Scheme (MEA), Nehru Memorial Scholarship Scheme (ICCR) Maulana Azad Scholarship Scheme and Rajiv Gandhi Scholarship Scheme), they are entitled for return economy class air-fares from Colombo to Chennai and 3rd AC Train fare from Airport to the place of study in India, if so required. No payment to be released without submission of Original ticket bill and boarding pass.

(C) Guidelines for Medical Insurance for foreign students studying in India under ICCR Scholarship Schemes

- (i) As per the latest ICCR guidelines, Medical Insurance is compulsory for the students at their cost. Students may buy medical insurance in their country before departure. It is up to the students to select the insurance package.
- (ii) *ZOs/SZOs/RPOs should ensure that the student has procured Medical Insurance Policy for a value of INR. 5.00 Lakhs before release of Advance Stipend to the students.*

(D) Guidelines with respect to deduction of stipend of ICCR sponsored international students for Ex-India period

Guidelines on payment of stipend to ICCR sponsored international students prescribe that students who travel abroad during the academic year are not entitled to stipend for the period they remain out of India. The guidelines have been reviewed and now stand amended to the extent indicated below:-

- (i) Ex-India period will continue to be deducted from the stipend of the students as per the current practice i.e. "If any student remains in his country for more than one month, stipend for complete duration of Ex-India will be deducted". However, HRA will be paid for maximum period of two months during Ex-India period
- (ii) To ensure the valid enrolment of students, in addition to the submission of Joining Report (JR) in the beginning of the academic year, half-yearly certificate to be issued by the competent authority of the University/Institute confirming continuation of studies by the student may be obtained by ZOs/SZOs/RPOs.
- (iii) Students should keep informed the Zonal/Sub Zonal Office/University about their movement within India in advance. If, leaving for their country/abroad, intimation or permission from Zonal/Sub Zonal Office should be obtained.

- (iv) Any of the norms inconsistent with the above stands amended to that extent.

(E) Guidelines for revival/extension of scholarship in r/o of students whose scholarship had been ceased as they had failed to clear their examination

1. The Competent Authority has decided that decision of revival/extension of Scholarship in r/o existing students should be taken up by ZOs/SZOs/RPOs at their own level without referring to Headquarters on the basis of following course duration:-
 - (i) Undergraduate – 36 Months
 - (ii) Undergraduate Engineering courses – 48 Months
 - (iii) Post-Graduate – 24 Months
 - (iv) Ph.D – 36 to 66 Months (After 3 years, ROs should obtain recommendation letter for the duration required for completion of his/her course including viva voice by his/her Guide/Supervisor.
 - (v) Maximum one-year (6 to 12 Months) extension is admissible only for final year Afghan Students of UG/PG courses.
 - (vi) In addition to the above, the students may be released Scholarship till the declaration of their consolidated results of all the semesters/final year plus 21 days for preparation of his/her departure (on production of final departure ticket from India).
 - (vii) *Headquarters may invariably be kept informed of extension/revival of scholarship of individual student. The Gyan Setu App may also be updated accordingly.*
2. In extraordinary circumstances where student has been suspended by the college/University and has been found to be involved in illegal activities, only then the advise of Headquarters should be sought.
3. While releasing scholarship to the students, whose scholarship has been revived, it may be ensured that they have been promoted to next class.
4. ICCR has discontinued the provision of extension of Scholarship in r/o any new student except from Afghanistan who would be joining in Academic Year 2021-22 and onwards.

(F) Guidelines for return journey to home country

- (i) Student should leave the country immediately after the completion of their studies. Under normal circumstances, the time gap between completion of studies and final departure should not exceed one month.
- (ii) Student should submit his/her request for return leg air ticket after successful completion of his/her course at least 15 days prior to the journey.
- (iii) If a student decides to return to his/her country before the completion of the course, he/she also would not be entitled for a return passage. The expenditure would need to be borne by the student himself/herself.

- (iv) ICCR will not pay airfares or any other expenses related to students travelling outside India during vacations or during the duration of the course.

(G) Guidelines for Scholarship Schemes (other than Afghan Students) for new students

In case a new student fails in first year, his/her ICCR Scholarship would be suspended for one year and he/she would have to self-finance his/her studies. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails second time, his/her Scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have the option to complete his/her course as a self finance student. In any case, scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course. Example is given here under:

A student who joined in July 2024 and joins onwards:-

- (i) Upon declaration of results :
- a) If a student is promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will continue.
 - b) If student fails, and is not promoted to the next class, his/her scholarship will be suspended and can be revived once he/she clears the 1st year (provided he/she clears the exam at the end of 2nd year).
 - c) If the student fails again, the scholarship will stand terminated with no recourse for revival.
 - d) Scholarship will stand terminated if student fails in 2nd year/any subsequent year and is not promoted in the next class/stage.
 - e) Student whose Scholarship is terminated will not be eligible for return air ticket (if the scheme allows air ticket).
 - f) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/ barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

Guidelines for Afghan Scholarship Schemes:-

- (i) In case a new student fails and is not promoted to next class in first year, his/her Scholarship may be extended by one year. If the student fails again, and is not promoted to next class, he/she would need to self finance his/her studies till he/she clears 1st year. Scholarship may be revived from next year (at the end of 2nd year) provided student clears the first year. In case student fails more than twice, his/her scholarship will stand terminated and he/she would have to complete his/her course as a self finance student. No extension (i.e. scholarship for additional year) be given after completion of 1st Year. In any case scholarship would not be given for more than the prescribed length of course (plus one year extension).
- (ii) The Council will not extend the scholarship period if student is detained/ barred from appearing in the exam due to shortage of attendance or malpractice.

Guidelines for AYUSH Scholarship Scheme

- a) Applicant should be necessarily of 18 years age at the time of admission in Indian Universities/Institutes. There is no upper age limit.
- b) Applicant has to apply on A2A portal for AYUSH Scholarship Scheme
- c) No application will be accepted after last date of application.
- d) The application will be processed only for the course applied for. No request for the change of course will be entertained later.
- e) The candidate has to fill 05 choices of Universities/Institutes in the application in order of preference.
- f) If no seats are available in the choice of University given by the candidate, the allocation of University will be done by the Ministry of AYUSH in other University as per the availability of seats.
- g) Ministry of AYUSH may decide about the selection criteria from time to time.
- h) The medium of teaching will be English and/ or Hindi.
- i) Equivalence certificate for the foreign candidates is obtained by the Ministry of AYUSH/ICCR from Association of Indian Universities (AIU). There will be no reimbursement of the Equivalence fee paid by the scholars to AIU.
- j) Candidate has to confirm/ deny the offer of admission within 15 days of receiving the offer.
- k) No request for transfer of University will be entertained once the admission is confirmed.
- l) No request for transfer of University in the middle of session or at any stage in the middle of course will be entertained.
- m) It is compulsory for AYUSH scholars to procure medical insurance policy with minimum sum assured for Indian Rupees Five Lakhs per annum.
- n) There is no provision of revival/extension of scholarship.
- o) Economy class Airfare by shortest route will be provided to the scholars once at the time of admission by respective Indian Mission and once after completion of the course by ICCR.
- p) Expenditure on laboratory, chemicals and other related incidental charges will be borne by the scholars.
- q) Any request related to family members such as endorsement of visa, accommodation or any other assistance will not be entertained.
- r) No allowances/fee other than mentioned in the financial norms will be provided/reimbursed.
- s) Any matter not covered above will be referred to Ministry of AYUSH whose decision will be final.

Eligibility Criteria

Undergraduate Courses

- a) **Bachelor of Ayurvedic Medicine and Surgery (BAMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- b) **Bachelor of Siddha Medicine and Surgery (BSMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- c) **Bachelor of Unani Medicine and Surgery (BUMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- d) **Bachelor of Homeopathic Medicine and Surgery (BHMS):** 5 ½ year degree course including one year mandatory clinical training (internship)
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling with science subjects (Physics, Chemistry & Biology)
- e) **B.Sc in Yoga:** 3 year course
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling
- f) **B.A. (Yoga Shastra):** 3 year course
Eligibility: 12 years of schooling

Post Graduate Courses

- a) **M.D. Ayurveda:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BAMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- b) **MD Siddha:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BSMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- c) **MD Unani:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BUMS degree recognized by Central Council of Indian Medicine (CCIM)
- d) **MD Homeopathy:** 3 year course
Eligibility: BHMS degree recognized by Central Council of Homeopathy (CCH)
- e) **M.Sc (Yoga) :** 2 year course
Eligibility: Any graduation degree

Ph.D. Courses

- a) **Ph.D in Ayurveda:** 3 year course
Eligibility: MD (Ayurveda) degree recognized by CCIM
- b) **Ph.D in Unani:** 3 year course
Eligibility: MD (Unani) degree recognized by CCIM

Note: Candidates may be instructed to visit the website of the concerned institute/university for details.

Financial Terms and Conditions of AYUSH Scholarship Scheme (BIMSTEC, Non-BIMSTEC, SEAR & Malaysia) under scheme for Promotion of International Cooperation in AYUSH

Courses	Scholarships Rates (In Rupees)
<u>LIVING ALLOWANCE (STIPEND)</u>	
Undergraduate	18,000/- P.M
MD	
• First Year	35,500/- P.M
• Second Year	38,000/- P.M
• Third Year	38,000/- P.M
Ph.D.	
a) First Year	43,500/- P.M
b) Second Year	43,500/- P.M
<u>CONTINGENT GRANT</u>	
Under-graduate & Diploma (Yoga)	4,500/- P.A
Ph.D Course/MD/MS	12,000/- P.A
<u>HOUSE RENT ALLOWANCE</u>	
a) In cities of Delhi, Bangalore, Kolkata, Chennai, Mumbai, Hyderabad & Pune	Not exceeding Rs. 6,500/- p.m. (as per actual)
b) In other cities	Not exceeding Rs. 5,000/- p.m. (as per actual)
Tuition Fee/Other Compulsory Fee	As per actual
<u>THESIS AND DISSERTATION EXPENSES</u>	
For Ph.D. Scholar	10,000/-
For MD/MS and other courses required submission of project	7,000/-
<u>To and From AIRFARE</u>	
For all courses	Economy class Airfare by shortest/ cheapest route will be provided to the scholars once at the time of admission and once after completion of the course for travel from the capital of their country to airport nearest to the Institute in India.
	At the time of Admission air ticket would be provided by the respective Indian Mission.
	After completion of course air ticket would be provided by the ICCR.
